THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE MEMORY SUPERCYCLE THESIS

The Peak That Came Early

The memory industry is earning more money, more quickly, than at any point in its fifty-year history. SK hynix reported a 76 per cent operating margin in the second quarter. Micron has guided to an 86 per cent gross margin for the quarter now ending. Samsung's chip division made a record profit while its phone division made its first ever loss, because the phone division has to buy what the chip division sells.

And yet every large memory share has fallen a long way from its high. SK hynix closed on Friday 42 per cent below its fifty-two-week peak. Micron is 20 per cent below its record close of 25 June. SanDisk is down almost a third from the same day. The operating results and the share prices are now pointing in opposite directions, and have been for two months.

A reframe worth holding onto

The question is not whether memory is scarce. It plainly is, and the scarcity is documented in contract prices, in lead times and in the profit statements of four companies. The question is how many quarters of scarcity remain unsold, and how much of the remainder has already been fixed by contract at yesterday's price. A shortage is a level. An equity is a claim on a rate of change. The two peak at different times, and this year they have peaked about eight weeks apart.

Method. Every external figure in this edition is attributed to a named source with an as-of date and was verified at the time of writing. Share prices are last traded closes, mostly Friday 21 August 2026. Where a number is a forecast, it is labelled as one and the forecaster is named. The internal Heyokha Wiki was unreachable for the whole of this run — see the sources note on the final page — so the internal view is represented only as far as the archive of previous Field Guides records it, and is labelled accordingly. No Wiki page was read for this edition. The bull and bear cases below were therefore built from external reporting and from tensions inside the companies' own published results, which is a weaker foundation than the house standard and is flagged again at the end.

Consider a ferry operator on a river crossing. In January the road bridge upstream is closed for rebuilding, and the works are announced, credibly, to take two years. The ferry is suddenly the only way across. Fares triple in the first quarter, rise a further 60 per cent in the second, and by the third quarter the operator can still raise them, but only by a further fifteen per cent, because the drivers who cross every day have started leaving the car at home. The boat is now the most profitable business on the river, and its best month is still ahead of it: the queues are longest in the final winter before the bridge reopens. But a buyer valuing the ferry in month eight is not buying the best month. That buyer is buying sixteen remaining months of monopoly, then a lifetime of competing with a bridge — and each month that passes removes one of the sixteen without adding anything to the far side. The ferry's profits peak near the end. The ferry's *value* peaked the week the closure was announced and everybody understood it.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

76%

SK hynix operating margin in the second quarter of 2026, on revenue of ₩79.3tn and operating profit of ₩60.5tn. Revenue rose 257 per cent year on year, operating profit 557 per cent. *SK hynix 2Q26 results, 29 July 2026.*

+13–18%

Forecast quarter-on-quarter rise in conventional DRAM contract prices in the third quarter of 2026 — against roughly 60 per cent achieved in the second and 90 to 95 per cent in the first. *TrendForce survey, reported 4 July 2026.*

−42%

SK hynix shares at ₩1,730,000 on 21 August 2026 against a fifty-two-week high of ₩2,987,000, even after a 577 per cent twelve-month gain. *StockAnalysis / S&P Global Market Intelligence, 21 August 2026.*

What actually happened

Memory is the one part of the semiconductor industry that has always behaved like a commodity. Four companies of consequence make dynamic random-access memory — Samsung, SK hynix, Micron and, at the margin, China's ChangXin Memory Technologies. Their product is close to interchangeable, their capacity is decided two to three years ahead of the demand it serves, and historically their pricing has swung by factors rather than percentages. The 2026 upswing has been the most violent on record. Conventional DRAM contract prices rose 90 to 95 per cent quarter on quarter in the first three months of the year, then a further 58 to 63 per cent in the second, according to TrendForce. The benchmark DDR4 spot chip touched a record 42.45 dollars in early August. A 64-gigabyte DDR5 retail kit that cost a couple of hundred dollars last year reached 1,118 dollars.

The cause is not a factory fire or an export ban. It is an allocation decision taken thousands of times a day inside four fabs. High-bandwidth memory — the stacked DRAM bolted to every AI accelerator — consumes roughly three times the wafer area per gigabyte of ordinary DDR5, because stacking costs yield and the through-silicon plumbing costs area. Artificial-intelligence demand is expected to absorb about a fifth of global DRAM wafer output in 2026, and HBM is on track to take more than 30 per cent of DRAM revenue from about 8 per cent of the bits. Every wafer that goes to an accelerator is a wafer and a half of laptop memory that never existed. Total capacity has grown; conventional supply has shrunk.

The results have been extraordinary and are not in dispute. Micron's fiscal third quarter, ended 28 May and reported on 24 June, produced revenue of 41.5 billion dollars, up 346 per cent year on year, at an 84.9 per cent gross margin, with DRAM alone contributing 31.3 billion dollars. Guidance for the following quarter is 50 billion dollars of revenue at roughly 86 per cent gross margin. SK hynix crossed ₩100tn of first-half revenue for the first time. Samsung's Device Solutions division reported ₩127.5tn of revenue, up 357 per cent, and a record operating profit; its mobile division, buying memory at the same prices, recorded its first operating loss.

What changed in late June was not the earnings. It was the market's willingness to extrapolate them. Micron's record closing price was struck on 25 June, SanDisk's on the same day. Since then the operating news has been uniformly better and the shares have fallen. In the week to 21 August the American information-technology sector shed more than 3 per cent while long-dated Treasury yields pushed the thirty-year cash yield to 5.336 per cent, its highest since June 2007. Into that, both Korean majors announced the largest capital returns in their history: SK hynix a ₩40tn buyback with every repurchased share to be cancelled, roughly 29 billion dollars and 3.3 per cent of the register; Samsung, the following day, shareholder returns of up to ₩110tn for 2026, about 80 billion dollars.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A shortage is a level. An equity is a claim on a rate of change. Memory is scarcer today than it was in March and will very likely be scarcer still in December — and the shares have fallen throughout, because the *speed* at which prices rise peaked in the first quarter and the calendar on which new capacity arrives has not moved.

The mechanism, one wafer at a time

1. A wafer is committed

A fab starts a 300mm wafer. The node, the tooling and the cleanroom were decided two to three years earlier. Nothing about that decision can be changed inside a quarter, whatever the price does.

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2. It is allocated

Sent to HBM, the wafer yields roughly a third of the saleable bits it would as DDR5, because stacking costs yield and area. AI absorbs about a fifth of global DRAM wafer output in 2026.

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3. Bits fail to appear

Conventional supply contracts even as total wafer starts rise. Contract prices rise 90 to 95 per cent, then 58 to 63 per cent. DDR4 spot reaches a record 42.45 dollars.

→

4. The bill lands

Memory goes from 15 to 18 per cent of a PC's build cost to about 35 per cent. HP's memory bill roughly doubled sequentially. Retail prices rise 15 to 20 per cent; units fall.

Sources: TrendForce memory pricing surveys, reported 4 July 2026; Tom's Hardware on HBM wafer intensity, 2026; HP first-quarter fiscal 2026 earnings call, February 2026, and TrendForce channel reporting on Dell, HP, Lenovo and Asus price increases. Wafer-to-bit ratios are industry estimates, not company disclosures.

84.9%

Micron gross margin, fiscal third quarter to 28 May 2026, on revenue of 41.5bn dollars. Guidance for the quarter now ending is roughly 86 per cent. Company release, 24 June 2026.

35%

Memory as a share of the cost to build a PC, on HP's own disclosure, against 15 to 18 per cent a quarter earlier. The chief financial officer said memory costs roughly doubled sequentially. February 2026.

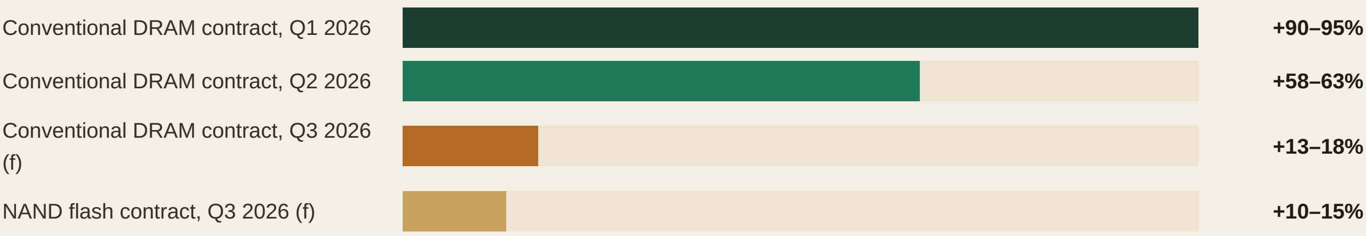
−12.9%

Forecast fall in global smartphone shipments in 2026, to 1.12bn units, about 160m fewer handsets, with average selling prices up 14 per cent to a record 523 dollars. IDC, 2026.

Sources: Micron fiscal third-quarter 2026 release, 24 June 2026; HP first-quarter fiscal 2026 earnings call as reported by The Register and PC Gamer, 25 February 2026; IDC smartphone and PC forecast revisions, 2026.

The rate of change, quarter by quarter

The single most important series in this theme is not the price of memory. It is the change in the price of memory, and its shape is unambiguous.



Bars are illustrative and scaled to the mid-point of each quarter-on-quarter range; they are not to a common absolute scale and do not compound. Source: TrendForce memory pricing survey as reported 4 July 2026. The first two figures are realised, the second two are forecasts. TrendForce attributes the third-quarter deceleration to buyers' unwillingness and inability to absorb further increases, not to any improvement in supply, and notes that a portion of server DRAM is now covered by long-term supply agreements that cap achievable prices.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

The useful question is not how tight memory is. It is how many quarters of tightness remain, how much of that has already been sold forward at a fixed price, and who is left holding the boat when the bridge reopens. *Peak profit and peak value are different events, and the second one happens first.*

What has actually shifted

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
The pricing impulse has decelerated	Conventional DRAM contract prices: +90–95 per cent quarter on quarter in Q1 2026, +58–63 per cent in Q2, +13–18 per cent guided for Q3 (TrendForce, 4 July 2026)	Slower growth is still growth, and the absolute price level keeps setting records, which is what the profit statement is made of. But an equity discounts the second derivative, and the second derivative turned five months ago.
The brake is demand, not supply	TrendForce attributes the Q3 cooldown explicitly to consumer-electronics makers' inability to absorb higher costs, with no improvement in supply	It confirms the shortage is physical and unresolved. It also means the price ceiling is now a customer's budget rather than a fab's output — a much softer thing to underwrite.
Cash has begun leaving the industry	SK hynix: ₩40tn buyback, 24.07m shares (3.3 per cent) to be cancelled, announced 19–20 August 2026. Samsung: returns of up to ₩110tn in 2026, announced 21 August	Cancelling a tenth of the equity over time is real value transfer at a forward multiple near four times. It is also what managements do when reinvesting the next dollar looks less attractive than retiring stock.
Spot has given way to contract	Micron disclosed roughly 100bn dollars of customer agreements alongside its June results; TrendForce says long-term agreements now moderate server DRAM pricing	Visibility of that length has never existed in this industry and justifies a higher multiple. It also removes the upside from any further tightening, and locks the seller into today's price if scarcity worsens.
The end market is shrinking	IDC now forecasts 2026 PC shipments −11.3 per cent, from 284.7m units to 252.5m, revised from −2.4 per cent in November 2025. Smartphones −12.9 per cent to 1.12bn	Fewer, dearer devices raise the memory content per dollar of end demand and free wafers for servers. They also destroy the volume base that has always underwritten the industry's fixed costs between AI cycles.
The relief has a date	Micron's Idaho fab starts DRAM production mid-2027 and Hiroshima targets 2028; SK hynix has pulled the M15X cleanroom forward to February 2027; Samsung's P5 is due in 2028	Nothing arrives soon enough to break the next four quarters, which is the bull case. It also means the shortage now has a published expiry, and every quarter that passes is one fewer quarter of it.

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The scarcity is physical and dated.** TrendForce judges that meaningful capacity expansion is unlikely before late 2027 or 2028. Micron's Idaho fab does not make DRAM until mid-2027, Hiroshima not until 2028, Samsung's P5 not until 2028. Four more quarters of tightness are close to arithmetic.
- **Nothing about HBM is cyclical in the old sense.** Accelerator memory is co-designed, qualified years ahead and contracted. SK hynix began mass HBM4 shipments in the second quarter and plans a sharp second-half increase. This is a specification business, not a spot business.
- **The multiples are not boom multiples.** SK hynix trades at 7.6 times trailing and about 4.2 times forward earnings after a 577 per cent twelve-month gain. Thirty-nine analysts carry a consensus target of ₩3.17m, some 83 per cent above the last price.
- **Cash is being returned at scale, not reinvested into a glut.** SK hynix will cancel 3.3 per cent of its shares outright; Samsung has flagged up to 80bn dollars of returns for 2026. Capital discipline is the variable that broke every previous memory cycle, and it is visibly better.
- **Demand is contracted, not hoped for.** Micron disclosed roughly 100bn dollars of customer agreements. Customer-side inventories are estimated at seven to nine weeks against the fifteen to thirty-one weeks that preceded past crashes.
- **The downstream squeeze frees capacity for the best customer.** Falling PC and handset units release wafers for server memory at three times the revenue per bit. Weak consumer demand is, perversely, a supply-side positive for the mix.

The bear case

- **The rate of change has already halved twice.** From +90–95 per cent to +58–63 per cent to a forecast +13–18 per cent in three quarters. Every memory cycle in history has been sold on the second derivative, and the second derivative turned in the first quarter.
- **The customer has run out of money, not appetite.** TrendForce is explicit that the third-quarter cooldown is buyers refusing and failing to absorb, with supply unimproved. IDC has cut its 2026 PC forecast from −2.4 per cent to −11.3 per cent in nine months. Demand destruction of that speed rarely stops on command.
- **Earnings quality deserves scrutiny.** SK hynix reported a second-quarter net profit of ₩93.9tn on revenue of ₩79.3tn — a net margin above 100 per cent, which by definition rests on items below the operating line. A trailing price-earnings ratio built on that base is not what it appears.
- **The supply response is enormous and already funded.** A reported 870bn dollar Korean expansion programme, a Korean state ambition to double DRAM capacity within five years, SK hynix pulling M15X forward to February 2027 and weighing a new Japanese plant, Micron's 200bn dollar American plan. Capital discipline is being abandoned in public.
- **A fourth supplier has arrived with state funding.** ChangXin Memory listed on the Star Market on 27 July 2026, raising Rmb57.9bn, already holding about 7.7 per cent of the global DRAM market as the fourth-largest producer. Apacer's chief executive has warned module-maker supply could fall more than 70 per cent in 2027 — a sign of allocation chaos, not of a stable oligopoly.
- **Long-term agreements cut both ways.** Contracts that guarantee revenue also forfeit the upside of further scarcity, and they were struck at prices set months ago. TechInsights forecasts an industry downturn by 2027, with the potential for prices to fall by half within a few quarters.

Where the internal and external views diverge

The internal record, as preserved in this Field Guide's own archive rather than read directly this morning, leans sceptical on the quality of artificial-intelligence demand. The Wiki's AI Capex page is recorded as resting heavily on White Box, whose 4 August issue was titled around markets not trusting the AI trade, and on Greed & Fear's work on hyperscaler free-cash-flow deterioration and remaining performance obligations. The external evidence assembled here points the other way on precisely that question. A 76 per cent operating margin at SK hynix, an 86 per cent gross margin guided at Micron and roughly 100bn dollars of disclosed customer agreements are the hardest available evidence that the accelerator build-out is contracted cash rather than aspiration — because someone has already paid for the memory. The conflict is not resolved here. It is possible for the memory bill to be real and prepaid and for the returns on the assets it feeds to be disappointing; that is what a capital-goods boom looks like from the inside. The honest position is that the memory numbers settle the question of whether the money is being spent, and say nothing at all about whether it should be.

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Nvidia results, Wednesday 26 August, after the close	Consensus is 93 to 95bn dollars of revenue, up 67 to 75 per cent. The relevant line is not revenue but the tone on accelerator supply through 2027.	Accelerator units are the numerator of HBM demand. A cautious 2027 comment removes the one part of the memory bid that is not price-sensitive.
HP fiscal third quarter, the same afternoon	Consensus revenue about 14.4bn dollars. The disclosure to look for is whether memory has stayed near 35 per cent of build cost, and whether price rises have stuck.	It is the clearest read on whether the cost is being passed on or absorbed — which decides how much longer the pricing can run.
Fourth-quarter contract price guidance	TrendForce and its peers will publish the next quarter-on-quarter range in September. The question is whether the number begins with a one or a zero.	A single-digit or negative print would mark the end of the pricing impulse regardless of how tight physical supply remains.
DDR4 and DDR5 spot prices	Spot led contract on the way up, with DDR4 peaking at a record 42.45 dollars in early August. Spot will lead on the way down.	It is the only high-frequency, unnegotiated price in the complex and the earliest available warning.
Buyback execution against fab commitments	SK hynix has three months to execute ₩40tn of repurchases while also weighing a plant in Miyagi that could absorb tens of trillions of won.	Which of the two is actually funded reveals what the board believes about the duration of the shortage, more reliably than any statement.
ChangXin output and the Samsung intellectual-property case	The new fourth supplier is expanding on state capital while facing a court claim over the use of Samsung technology.	Chinese bit growth is the main mechanism by which the oligopoly's discipline could fail before the Korean and American fabs open.

Three postures, not one answer

Own the cash return

Hold the leaders on a forward multiple near four times and let the buyback do the work, treating the shortage as a source of cash rather than a story about growth. **The cost:** the multiple may never expand, and a de-rating of the earnings base can outrun the reduction in share count. Buying a peak earnings stream cheaply is still buying a peak earnings stream.

Own the toll on the response

Hold the equipment makers, who are paid to build the capacity that ends the shortage and are indifferent to the price of a bit. Tokyo Electron has already raised fiscal 2027 guidance to record levels. **The cost:** the payment stops when the orders do, and the boards placing those orders are simultaneously announcing record buybacks.

Own the other side of the bill

Hold the device makers whose largest input cost is peaking, on the view that the memory line item is nearer its top than its bottom. **The cost:** relief is at least four quarters away on any published fab schedule, and unit demand is falling now. That is a long stretch of negative operating leverage to sit through for a mean reversion with no date.

The companies named below are illustrative of how this theme is expressed in listed markets. They are NOT recommendations, and their inclusion implies no view on their merits, valuation or suitability for any portfolio.

000660 KS

₩1,730,000
21 Aug 2026

SK hynix

The purest listed expression of the theme, and the sharpest illustration of its paradox. Second-quarter revenue of ₩79.3tn at a 76 per cent operating margin, first-half revenue above ₩100tn for the first time, HBM4 in mass shipment — and a share price 42 per cent below its fifty-two-week high of ₩2,987,000. Trailing earnings put it on 7.6 times; the forward figure is nearer 4.2 times. The market capitalisation is ₩1,261tn and the beta is 2.41, which is the market's own statement about how it regards the durability of these earnings. The ₩40tn buyback announced on 19 August, with all 24.07m shares to be cancelled, lifted the stock more than 12 per cent in a day.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether the buyback and a possible Miyagi plant are both funded, and the ex-dividend date of 28 August.

005930 KS

₩281,500
21 Aug 2026

Samsung Electronics

The only company that sits on both sides of the trade, which makes it the cleanest natural experiment available. Device Solutions produced ₩127.5tn of second-quarter revenue, up 357 per cent year on year, and a record operating profit; the mobile division, buying the same memory at the same prices, recorded its first ever operating loss of ₩0.7tn. The consolidated result flatters neither the bull nor the bear. On 21 August the company flagged shareholder returns of up to ₩110tn for 2026, roughly 80bn dollars, a day after its smaller rival. The shares are about 25 per cent below a fifty-two-week high of ₩374,500.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether the mobile loss widens in the third quarter, which is the internal cost of the memory margin.

MU

$966.78
21 Aug 2026

Micron Technology

The Western pure play, and the company that has published the most striking single number of the cycle: an 84.9 per cent gross margin on 41.5bn dollars of revenue in the quarter to 28 May, with DRAM alone at 31.3bn dollars and adjusted earnings of 25.11 dollars a share. Guidance for the quarter now closing is 50bn dollars at roughly 86 per cent. Against that, the shares closed at 966.78 dollars on 21 August, down 0.8 per cent on the day and about 20 per cent below the record close of 1,213.37 dollars struck on 25 June. Roughly 100bn dollars of customer agreements were disclosed alongside the June results.

WATCH NEXT

> The fiscal fourth-quarter report in late September, and specifically the first guide that is not a record.

SNDK

$1,596.08
22 Aug 2026

SanDisk

The NAND flash equivalent, and the highest-beta instrument in the complex: a fifty-two-week range of 46.01 to 2,354.39 dollars tells its own story about how recently this was a distressed asset. NAND contract prices are forecast to rise 10 to 15 per cent quarter on quarter in the third quarter, a slower path than DRAM's. At an investor day on 13 August the company set out double-digit revenue growth through 2030 and an 80 per cent non-GAAP gross margin target. Twenty of twenty-one covering analysts are positive, with an average target of 2,126 dollars. The shares are roughly a third below their 25 June record close.

WATCH NEXT

> Client SSD pricing, where PC makers built inventory in the first half and are now resisting increases.

8035 JP

¥56,660
mid-Aug 2026

Tokyo Electron

The toll collector on the supply response. Memory capacity cannot be added without deposition, etch and cleaning tools, and the company reported record first-quarter fiscal 2027 revenue of ¥732.3bn and raised full-year guidance to record sales and margins, citing AI and memory demand. It is the one position in the theme that is paid whether the price of a bit rises or falls, provided the capital expenditure continues. That is also the vulnerability: the orders it depends on are the same orders that end the shortage, and its boards' newfound enthusiasm for buybacks is a competing use of the same cash.

WATCH NEXT

> Order commentary for the second half of 2026, which management has framed as the start of a new capital-expenditure leg.

HPQ

$29.99
19 Aug 2026

HP Inc

The clearest listed proxy for the cost of the shortage rather than its reward. Management disclosed that memory had reached about 35 per cent of the cost of building a PC, against 15 to 18 per cent a quarter earlier, with the chief financial officer noting costs roughly doubled sequentially. Full-year non-GAAP earnings guidance of 2.90 to 3.20 dollars a share and free cash flow of 2.8 to 3.0bn dollars have been maintained, but the chief executive has said the second half could be especially difficult. The shares are up about 35 per cent this year, which is not the behaviour of a company being destroyed.

WATCH NEXT

> Fiscal third-quarter results on 26 August, and whether the 15 to 20 per cent retail price increases have held.

The bottom line

What was repriced in late June was not the memory shortage. It was the duration of the memory shortage. Nothing that has been published since 25 June has made the physical position looser — contract prices are still rising, spot DDR4 set a record in August, and no new wafer of consequence arrives before February 2027. What has changed is that the industry, its customers and its regulators have all now put dates on the far side: a Korean expansion programme, a Japanese plant under consideration, an American fab in mid-2027, a Chinese fourth supplier already at 7.7 per cent of the market. A shortage with a published expiry is worth less than a shortage of unknown length, even while it is getting worse.

The evidence genuinely cuts both ways, and it would be dishonest to pretend otherwise. The bull can point to a forward multiple near four times, roughly 100bn dollars of contracted revenue and inventories well below crash levels; the bear can point to a pricing impulse that has fallen from ninety-odd per cent to the mid-teens in three quarters, to a customer base shrinking at more than a tenth a year, and to a net margin above 100 per cent that flatters the trailing multiple everyone is quoting. The reasonable inference is that peak profit for these companies is probably still one to three quarters ahead, that peak share price may well be behind, and that the two facts are not in conflict. The next test is specific and close: Nvidia and HP report within hours of each other on Wednesday afternoon — the demand for the memory and the bill for it, on the same day.

Editorial note. This Field Guide is educational commentary prepared for internal use at Heyokha Brothers. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation to buy or sell any security, and not personalised to any individual's circumstances. Named companies illustrate how a theme is expressed in public markets; their inclusion implies no view on their merits. External figures are attributed with as-of dates and were verified at the time of writing; markets move and figures date quickly. Internal Heyokha Wiki views are the opinions of named third-party research providers, labelled as views rather than verified forecasts; where Wiki content itself cites third parties, those underlying claims have not been independently confirmed. Where internal and external views conflict, the conflict has been stated rather than resolved. This edition carries an additional and material caveat: the internal Wiki could not be reached at all during this run, so the internal leg is second-hand and should be weighted accordingly.

Sources and update notes

Internal — Heyokha Wiki. No Wiki page was read for this edition. The Heyokha Wiki server was not present among the available tools at any point in this run, and no page, section, creation date or last-reviewed date can therefore be quoted. What follows is recorded second-hand from the Field Guide archive rather than from the Wiki itself. The edition of 4 August 2026 records the *AI Capex* theme page as active, created 23 June 2026 and last reviewed 4 August 2026, and as relying principally on White Box (Ignacio de Gregorio Noblejas) — issues of 13 June, 9 July, 28 July, 31 July (on memory results specifically) and 4 August 2026 — together with Greed & Fear (Chris Wood) issues of 2, 23 and 30 July 2026 on hyperscaler credit, remaining performance obligations and free-cash-flow deterioration, and with 13D Research and Michael Burry (23 May 2026) cited for the structurally bullish and bearish framings respectively. Whether a dedicated memory theme page exists, and what it says, could not be established.

Limitation on the internal view. Two limitations apply, and the second is unusual. First, on the archive's own account the relevant Wiki page is heavily concentrated in a single provider, White Box, which supplies most of the high-frequency July and August 2026 evidence on both AI demand and memory results; the archive also records that provider reversing his own profitability view within a fortnight in late July 2026, so the internal position on this subject has not been stable. Second, and more seriously, this run had no internal access whatsoever. Every argument, figure and counter-argument above comes from external reporting and from tensions inside the companies' own published results. Readers should treat this edition as an externally sourced piece with an internal framing bolted on from memory, not as a synthesis of the two.

External sources. (1) SK hynix second-quarter 2026 results, reported 29 July 2026 — revenue ₩79.3187tn, operating profit ₩60.5426tn (76 per cent margin), net profit ₩93.9226tn, revenue +257 per cent and operating profit +557 per cent year on year, first-half revenue above ₩100tn, HBM4 mass shipments begun: SK hynix newsroom and TelecomLead, 29 July 2026. (2) SK hynix share data — ₩1,730,000 close on 21 August 2026, +2.31 per cent on the day, fifty-two-week range ₩245,000–₩2,987,000, market capitalisation ₩1,260.94tn, trailing price-earnings 7.60 and forward 4.17, beta 2.41, twelve-month consensus target ₩3,170,279 across 39 analysts, ex-dividend 28 August 2026: StockAnalysis, data from S&P Global Market Intelligence and Twelve Data, last checked 21 August 2026. (3) SK hynix buyback — board approval for repurchase and cancellation of about 24.07m shares, 3.3 per cent of those issued, ₩40tn or about 29bn dollars, shares +12 per cent in Seoul: CNBC and Reuters, 20 August 2026. (4) SK hynix considering a memory plant in Miyagi prefecture, Japan, potentially tens of trillions of won: Reuters citing Hankyoreh, 21 August 2026. (5) Samsung Electronics second quarter 2026 — Device Solutions revenue ₩127.5tn (88.2bn dollars), +357 per cent year on year and +56 per cent sequentially, record divisional operating profit, mobile division first ever operating loss of ₩0.7tn: Tech Times and Blocks & Files, 29–31 July 2026. (6) Samsung shareholder returns of up to ₩110tn (about 80bn dollars) for

2026: Invezz and MarketWatch, 21 August 2026. (7) Samsung share price ₩281,500 on 21 August 2026, fifty-two-week range ₩67,500–₩374,500: Google Finance and stockanalysis.com, 21–23 August 2026. (8) Micron fiscal third quarter 2026, quarter ended 28 May and reported 24 June 2026 — revenue 41.46bn dollars (+346 per cent year on year, +74 per cent sequentially), gross margin 84.9 per cent, adjusted earnings 25.11 dollars a share, DRAM revenue 31.3bn dollars or 76 per cent of the total, fourth-quarter guidance 50.0bn dollars plus or minus 1.0bn at about 86 per cent gross margin, roughly 100bn dollars of customer agreements disclosed: Micron press release and investor slides, 24 June 2026. (9) Micron share price 966.78 dollars on 21 August 2026, down 0.775 per cent from 974.33 dollars, fifty-two-week range 114.25–1,255.00 dollars, record close 1,213.37 dollars on 25 June 2026: stockinvest.us and Macrotrends, 21–22 August 2026. (10) SanDisk 1,596.08 dollars as of 22 August 2026, day range 1,570.01–1,614.06, fifty-two-week range 46.01–2,354.39 dollars, record close 2,335.00 dollars on 25 June 2026, twenty of twenty-one analysts positive with an average target of 2,126.17 dollars, investor day of 13 August 2026 setting out double-digit revenue growth to 2030 and an 80 per cent non-GAAP gross margin target: Macrotrends, Robinhood and Forbes, August 2026. (11) Memory pricing — conventional DRAM contract prices +90 to 95 per cent quarter on quarter in the first quarter of 2026, +58 to 63 per cent in the second and a forecast +13 to 18 per cent in the third, NAND flash +10 to 15 per cent in the third, deceleration attributed to buyers' inability to absorb rather than to improved supply, long-term agreements moderating server DRAM pricing, meaningful capacity expansion judged unlikely before late 2027 or 2028, Samsung seeking up to 20 per cent on third-quarter contracts and HBM3E supply prices raised about 20 per cent: TrendForce surveys as reported by Tom's Hardware, 4 July 2026, and Astute Group, 2026. (12) Spot prices — benchmark DDR4 chip at a record 42.45 dollars in early August 2026, a 64GB DDR5 kit at 1,118 dollars after a 485 per cent rise: tech-insider.org and itechguides, August 2026. (13) HBM intensity — roughly three times the wafer capacity of DDR5 per gigabyte, AI absorbing about 20 per cent of global DRAM wafer output in 2026, HBM above 30 per cent of DRAM revenue on about 8 per cent of output: Tom's Hardware and TrendForce, December 2025 and 2026. (14) End-market forecasts — IDC 2026 PC shipments −11.3 per cent, from 284.7m units in 2025 to 252.53m, revised from −2.4 per cent in November 2025 and −8.9 per cent in January 2026, with market value nonetheless +1.6 per cent to 274bn dollars; smartphones −12.9 per cent to 1.12bn units with average selling prices +14 per cent to a record 523 dollars; Gartner PC forecast −10.4 per cent: IDC blog and Tom's Hardware, 2026. (15) HP — memory about 35 per cent of PC build cost against 15 to 18 per cent a quarter earlier, costs roughly doubling sequentially per chief financial officer Karen Parkhill, full-year non-GAAP earnings guidance 2.90–3.20 dollars and free cash flow 2.8–3.0bn dollars maintained, fiscal third-quarter results due 26 August 2026 with consensus revenue of 14.39bn dollars, share price 29.99 dollars on 19 August 2026 and up 34.54 per cent year to date; Dell, HP, Lenovo and Asus retail price increases of 15 to 20 per cent: The Register and PC Gamer, 25 February 2026; TrendForce channel reporting, December 2025; ad-hoc-news and stockinvest.us, August 2026. (16) Capacity schedule — Micron 200bn dollar United States programme with Idaho DRAM production from mid-2027 and 9.6bn dollars in Hiroshima targeting 2028; SK hynix M15X first cleanroom brought forward from May 2027 to February 2027, twenty additional low-numerical-aperture EUV tools by 2027, an additional 15bn dollar commitment in March 2026; Samsung P5 at Pyeongtaek due 2028; a reported 870bn dollar combined Korean expansion plan and a state ambition to double DRAM capacity within five years: TechPowerUp, TrendForce and Tom's Hardware, March to August 2026. (17) ChangXin Memory Technologies — listed on the Shanghai Star Market on 27 July 2026 under 688825, raising Rmb57.92bn, about 7.7 per cent of the global DRAM market and the fourth-largest producer; litigation over the alleged use of Samsung intellectual property: CNBC, 27 July 2026, and Tom's Hardware, August 2026. (18) Cycle indicators — customer-side inventories estimated at seven to nine weeks against fifteen to thirty-one weeks before past crashes; TechInsights forecasting an industry downturn by 2027 with potential price declines of 50 per cent or more within a few quarters; Apacer's chief executive warning module-maker DRAM supply could fall more than 70 per cent in 2027: Luminix industry analysis and Tom's Hardware, 2026. (19) Tokyo Electron — ¥56,660 in mid-August 2026, down 5.71 per cent on the day; record fiscal 2027 first-quarter revenue of ¥732.3bn and raised full-year guidance citing AI and memory demand: Stockopedia and simplywall.st, August 2026. (20) Market backdrop — American information technology down more than 3 per cent in the week to 21 August 2026; thirty-year Treasury cash yield 5.336 per cent on 18 August 2026, the highest since June 2007; Nvidia fiscal second-quarter results due after the close on 26 August 2026 with consensus revenue of 93 to 95bn dollars, up 67 to 75 per cent; July personal consumption expenditures the same day and the Jackson Hole symposium from 27 August: CNBC week-ahead and Nasdaq, 21 August 2026, and MarketBeat earnings calendar.

Editorial choices made in this automated run. The Memory Supercycle was selected as the day's topic because the hot signal is unambiguous and because it survives the cooldown test cleanly. The archive in the HB Wiki Learning folder was read in full and parsed successfully: twenty-two dated editions, of which twenty-one fall inside the thirty-day window, yielding a cooldown set of fifteen topics — AI Capex, Gold Miners, Oil & Gas, Copper, Copper Smelting Bottleneck, Grid Equipment, Seat-Based Software, Software Unit Economics, Healthcare Rotation, Tanker Shipping, Uranium, Oil Chokepoint Risk, Energy Chokepoints, Fiscal Dominance and China Equities. Two filename conventions are present, the older "YYYY-MM-DD - Topic" form used to 3 August and the specified "YYYYMMDD Topic" form thereafter, and both were parsed. No memory or semiconductor-component edition appears anywhere in the archive, and the theme is distinct from AI Capex in the specific sense that the argument here concerns the pricing of a physical commodity input rather than the returns on artificial-intelligence investment. Two tool failures degraded this run and both are disclosed above. The Heyokha Wiki server was absent for the entire session, so steps 3 and 4 of the standard procedure could not be executed as designed: the entity-scoring exercise across the last twenty-one days of source summaries was impossible, and topic selection instead used external hot signal — the memory complex is the largest single divergence in global equities between reported results and share prices, and Wednesday's Nvidia and HP reports are the day's principal scheduled catalysts. The remote-devices bridge was also unavailable, but the archive folder proved to be directly readable, so the cooldown check was fully verified rather than inferred. Because no Wiki page could be opened, the topic name used in the filename was chosen editorially and may not correspond exactly to a Wiki page title, which will matter to tomorrow's parser. Company financial data services were not used; every figure comes from primary releases or dated news reporting.
